

To establish importance of a topic

- "It is well established that..."
- "Previous research has demonstrated..."
- "A growing body of evidence suggests..."
- "Numerous studies have
- "X has attracted the attention of biologists/ecologists because..."

To summarize another paper / synthesize past research

- "A key finding of this study was..."
- "Importantly, the authors noted that..."
- "Notably, the study showed..."
- "X et al argued that..."
- "Together, these results suggest that..."

To establish a gap in the research

- "Despite extensive research on X, less is known about Y"
- "It remains to be seen what the effect of X is on Y"
- "There is limited research exploring X"
- "Most studies seeking to study X have done Y. However, the role of Z is not clear..."
- "More research on X is needed to better understand Y..."
- "This research highlights the need for further investigation into..."

To introduce your idea

- "This study provides a foundation for..."
- "These findings are relevant for understanding..."
- "Building on this work, I aimed to..."
- "Whereas previous research focused on X, this study examines Y"
- "The goal of this study is to gain a better understanding of..."
- "To determine if X influences Y...we assessed the impact of..."

To describe disagreement or lack of clarity about a topic

- "In contrast to previous studies"
- "However, other research has found..."
- "These findings differ from those of..."
- "An alternative explanation has been proposed by..."

To explain a pattern or result

- “One possible explanation is that...”
- “This may be due to...”
- “These findings suggest that...”
- “A likely mechanism underlying this pattern is...”
- “It could be that / it is possible that...”

To describe significance

- “These results have important implications for...”
- “This study contributes to our understanding of...”
- “Our findings highlight the role of...”
- “This study provides a foundation for...”